

GRAVEFIELD GUARDIAN

Unique Large Construct (Evil, Extraplanar, Cursed)

STATISTICS

Hit Dice: 15d10+30 (112 hp)

Initiative: +1

Speed: 30 ft.

Armor Class: 21 (–1 size, +1 Dex, +11 natural), touch 10, flat-footed 20

Base Attack/Grapple: +11/+23

Attack: Oversized scythe +18 melee (2d6+12/17–20)

Full Attack: Oversized scythe +18/+13/+8 melee (2d6+12/17–20)

Space/Reach: 10 ft./10 ft.

Special Attacks: Reaping Blow, Cemetery Vines,

Vine Lash, Command Squashlings, Essence Harvest

Special Qualities: Construct traits, damage reduction, fire vulnerability, squashling bond, essence harvest

Saves: Fort +5, Ref +6, Will +7

Abilities: Str 26, Dex 12, Con —, Int 8, Wis 14, Cha 15

Skills: Listen +8, Spot +10, Intimidate +10

Feats: Cleave, Great Fortitude, Improved Bull Rush, Improved Sunder, Improved Toughness, Power Attack, Weapon Focus (scythe)

Environment: Cursed cemeteries and surrounding fields

Organization: Solitary (with Sinister Squashlings)

Challenge Rating: 12

Treasure: None

Alignment: Neutral Evil

Advancement: —

Level Adjustment: —

DESCRIPTION

The Gravefield Guardian is an enormous scarecrow-like construct bound to the cursed earth of the cemetery. Built from twisted wood, rusted iron, straw, and tattered farm clothing, it stands as a silent warden until intruders trespass upon the graveyard. Arcane script smolders beneath its outer shell, and its hollow, grinning head burns with an unnatural red-orange light. The Guardian serves as the focus of the curse, extending through the cemetery's vegetation and the sinister squashlings that infest the grounds. It feeds upon life, harvesting the essence of the creatures it slays to repair its own shattered form.

COMBAT

The Gravefield Guardian fights with deliberate, crushing strikes, combining its massive scythe with animated cemetery vines and swarms of squashlings. It uses its reach to control the battlefield, separating enemies and pinning them while its minions overwhelm them. The Guardian is relentless, showing no fear and no concern for the safety of the squashlings.

VINE BARRIER

Armor Class: 15

Hit Points: 25 per 5-foot section

Hardness: 5

Destroying a section creates an opening, but while the Guardian remains alive, a destroyed section regrows at the beginning of its next turn unless it was destroyed with fire.



SPECIAL ABILITIES

REAPING BLOW (Ex)

As a full-round action, the Guardian sweeps its scythe in a 10-foot semicircle. Creatures in the area must make a Reflex save (DC 19) or take 3d6+12 slashing damage (half on a successful save). Sinister squashlings caught in the sweep are also affected.

CEMETERY VINES (Su)

3/day, the Guardian commands the cemetery's vegetation within 60 feet. Creatures in the area must make a Reflex save (DC 19) or become entangled. The vines can form walls, cages, or barriers (see below).

VINE LASH (Ex)

The Guardian may animate a cemetery vine as a melee touch attack at 15 ft. reach (+15). A hit entangles the target (Str DC 20 or Escape Artist DC 20). The vine can also attempt a trip with an effective Strength of 22.

COMMAND SQUASHLINGS (Su)

The Guardian can mentally direct all Sinister Squashlings within 120 feet. This requires no action.

ESSENCE HARVEST (Su)

When the Guardian kills a living creature with its scythe, or when a living creature dies within 10 feet of it, the Guardian can absorb the creature's life essence. It immediately heals 5 hit points per Hit Dice of the slain creature (to a maximum of its normal hit point total). If the slain creature has 4 or more Hit Dice, the Guardian also gains fast healing 3 for 3 rounds as the stolen essence mends its form. Construct and undead creatures provide no usable essence.

SQUASHLING BOND (Su)

The Guardian is the magical anchor for the cemetery's sinister squashlings. While it lives, new squashlings can continue to emerge from the cursed vegetation. When it is destroyed, all animated squashlings immediately become ordinary pumpkins and gourds.